



Republic of the Philippines  
**House of Representatives**

**20<sup>th</sup> CONGRESS**

***First Regular Session***



**HOUSE BILL NO. 5209**

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**Introduced by Hon. Charisse Anne C. Hernandez**

**Lone District of Calamba, Laguna**

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**EXPLANATORY NOTE**

In recent years, the Philippines has experienced a dramatic expansion in internet and social media usage. According to surveys, approximately 73.9% of Filipinos between ages 10 to 64 use the internet for social media, exceeding their use for research and email. Internet-penetration has reached a level where digital media is no longer supplemental but central in how people get information, interact, and form opinions. Coinciding with this surge in digital engagement is a rising concern among Filipinos about disinformation and fake news.

In the 2025 Digital News Report by the Reuters Institute, 67% of Filipino respondents said they were worried or very worried about online disinformation, the highest rate since the Philippines has been included in the survey. Social media platforms are by far the most common places Filipinos encounter disinformation. Facebook leads (68%), followed by TikTok (48%), YouTube (39%), and others.

Relatedly, only a modest proportion of Filipinos feel confident in distinguishing fake information. About 65% report difficulty in telling whether online content is false; many often encounter fake or misleading news.

Besides disinformation, there are also issues of functional literacy — the capacity to understand, interpret, and make use of information. In the 2024 Functional Literacy, Education, and Mass Media Survey (FLEMMS), the basic literacy rate (reading, writing, computing) remains relatively high (~93.1%), but only 70.8% are functionally literate — meaning many Filipinos struggle with comprehension and application of information, especially in reading, understanding, and analyzing texts/media.

Moreover, youth are especially exposed and vulnerable. Many young Filipinos are among the first responders to new media content, given their higher familiarity and use of the Internet and social media. This exposure puts them at a greater risk of encountering, believing, or sharing misinformation.

Given this, there is a clear and urgent need for formal education in media literacy, information literacy, and responsible digital citizenship beginning as early as Grade 1. Early and structured instruction can help students develop critical thinking skills and enabling them to discern credible from non-credible sources. Youth have to learn fact-checking, verification of claims, and reliability of content—skills which are essential for living in a digital ecosystem.

Understand the ethical use of emerging technologies including artificial intelligence, privacy, safety, and the consequences of misuse. Guard against the erosion of public trust, social division arising from disinformation, and the harmful effects of misinformation on democratic processes.

Thus, the proposed Media Literacy for the Youth Act of 2025 aims to institutionalize media literacy as a core subject from Grade 1 onward, ensuring Filipino learners are better equipped to navigate, analyze, and responsibly use digital media and information.

Immediate passage of this bill is earnestly sought.

  
**CHARISSE ANNE C. HERNANDEZ**



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**AN ACT INSTITUTIONALIZING THE TEACHING OF MEDIA LITERACY AS PART  
OF THE CURRICULUM OF BASIC AND SECONDARY EDUCATION, AND  
APPROPRIATING FUNDS THEREFOR**

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress  
assembled:*

**SECTION 1. *Short Title.*** - This Act shall be known as the “Media Literacy for the Youth Act of 2025.”

**SEC. 2. *Declaration of Policy.*** - — It is the policy of the State to promote critical thinking, digital competence, fact-based reasoning, and ethical citizenship among Filipino learners by

integrating Digital, Media, and Information Literacy as an essential part of basic education, in order to combat disinformation, fake news, and the irresponsible use of digital and emerging technologies.

**SEC. 3. Coverage.** — Media Literacy shall be taught as a **core subject starting Grade 1**, and shall continue progressively through elementary, junior high school, and senior high school under the supervision of the Department of Education (DepEd).

**SEC. 4. Curriculum Content.** — The Media Literacy subject shall include, but not be limited to, the following:

- a. Introduction to media platforms and their purposes, age-appropriate to learners;
- b. Development of digital communication skills;
- c. Identifying facts and opinions, misinformation, and disinformation;
- d. Fact-checking methods and evaluating sources of information;
- e. Analyzing online advertisements and different digital communities;
- f. Responsible and ethical use of the internet and social media;
- g. Online safety, privacy, and cyber-hygiene;
- h. Prevention of cyberbullying and online exploitation;
- i. Intellectual property and respect for digital content;
- j. Constructive use of media for civic participation, learning, and advocacy;
- k. Navigation of mobile applications and tool;
- l. Responsible awareness and use of Artificial Intelligence technologies, including their risks, biases, and ethical implications;
- m. Producing digital content and information.

**SEC. 5. Implementing Rules and Regulations.** — Within six (6) months from the effectivity of this Act, the DepEd shall formulate and issue the rules and regulations necessary for its proper

implementation.

**SEC. 6. Appropriations.** — The funds necessary for the initial implementation of this Act shall be charged against the current year's appropriations of the Department of Education. Thereafter, the amount needed shall be included in the annual General Appropriations Act.

**SEC. 7. Separability Clause.** — If any provision of this Act is declared invalid or unconstitutional, the remaining provisions shall not be affected and shall remain in full force and effect.

**SEC. 8. Repealing Clause.** — All laws, decrees, executive orders, rules and regulations, and other issuances or parts thereof inconsistent with the provisions of this Act are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

**SEC. 9. Effectivity.** — This Act shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in the Official Gazette or in a newspaper of general circulation.

Approved,